PHASE 1: IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorming & Idea Prioritization – StaffSync

Field	Details
Date	21 October 2026
Team ID	Individual Project
Project Name	StaffSync – Modern Human Resource Management System
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

1. Introduction

StaffSync is a web-based Human Resource Management System (HRMS) designed to centralize routine HR activities in one platform. It aims to make employee information, attendance, leave requests, announcements, training, and team administration easier to manage. The application is being developed as an individual project using the MERN stack: MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, and Node.js.

2. Step 1 – Team Gathering and Problem Statement

As an individual project, the brainstorming and prioritization process focuses on identifying common HR-management problems and selecting features that can be delivered within the project scope.

Problem Statement

Organizations may manage employee records, attendance, leave approvals, announcements, and training through separate tools or manual processes. This can lead to duplicated data, delays, limited visibility, and difficulty tracking requests. StaffSync addresses this problem by providing a centralized system with role-based access for HR, managers, and employees.

3. Step 2 – Brainstorming, Idea Listing and Grouping

The following ideas were identified as potential features for StaffSync and grouped around the needs of HR administrators, managers, and employees.

Idea / Feature	Purpose
Employee and manager management	Maintain employee profiles, job details, manager assignments, and employee records.
Secure authentication and role-based access	Provide login, password hashing, JWT-based authentication, and permissions for HR, managers, and employees.
Attendance management	Allow employees to check in and check out, and let authorized staff review attendance records.

Leave management	Allow employees to submit and track leave requests; allow managers or HR to review requests according to permissions.
Announcements and notifications	Share company updates and notify users about relevant activities or status changes.
Training management	Publish training programs and allow employees to view or enroll in available training.
Dashboards and analytics	Show role-specific summaries and useful metrics, such as attendance and leave information.
Performance tracking	Support manager-led performance evaluations and provide a place to review evaluation records.
Search, filtering, and pagination	Help users navigate larger employee and record lists efficiently.
Responsive interface	Make core workflows usable on desktop and smaller screens.

4. Step 3 – Idea Prioritization

Ideas were prioritized based on their impact on essential HR workflows and their feasibility within an individual MERN application.

Priority Group	Selected Ideas
High priority – Core functionality	Authentication and role-based access; employee and manager records; attendance; leave requests and approvals; role-specific dashboards.
High priority – Security and reliability	Password hashing, protected routes and APIs, input validation, controlled data access, and reliable database connectivity.
Medium priority – Communication	Announcements, notifications, training programs, and performance tracking.
Medium priority – Usability	Search, filtering, pagination, responsive layouts, and clear status feedback.
Future enhancement	Advanced analytics, external HR/payroll integrations, and more sophisticated reporting.

5. Impact and Feasibility Assessment

Feature	Impact	Feasibility	Reason / Decision
Authentication and role-based access	High	High	Required for secure access across all roles.
Employee and manager management	High	High	Core data-management capability for HR operations.
Attendance and leave management	High	High	Frequent workflows with clear, testable outcomes.
Dashboards	High	Medium	Important for usability; built from available records.
Announcements and notifications	Medium	Medium	Useful communication features after core workflows.

Training and performance tracking	Medium	Medium	Adds value once roles and employee records are stable.
Advanced analytics and integrations	Medium	Low to Medium	Can be expanded after the core system is stable.

6. Selected Project Idea

The selected idea is StaffSync – Modern Human Resource Management System. It provides a centralized web application for employee records and common HR workflows, with separate permissions and dashboards for HR, managers, and employees. The initial scope focuses on secure access, employee management, attendance, leave management, and dashboards, followed by communication, training, and performance features.

7. Proposed Technology Stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React.js, React Router, Redux Toolkit, Axios, Bootstrap and existing UI components
Backend	Node.js and Express.js REST API
Database	MongoDB with Mongoose; planned cloud database: MongoDB Atlas
Authentication and security	JWT, bcryptjs, role-based access control, input validation, CORS, Helmet, dotenv
Development and testing	Git/GitHub, npm scripts, API tests, and frontend production build

8. Expected Outcome

StaffSync is intended to reduce fragmented HR administration by bringing key employee workflows into one application. Expected outcomes include easier record management, clearer attendance and leave tracking, role-appropriate access to information, and faster access to announcements and training information. Actual outcomes should be assessed through testing and user feedback.

9. Conclusion

The brainstorming and prioritization phase identified the most important HRMS workflows and ranked them by impact and feasibility. StaffSync was selected because its core features address practical HR needs and fit the proposed MERN stack. The next phase is to finalize requirements and design the application structure, database models, APIs, and user interfaces.

Note: This document adapts the supplied ideation template to StaffSync. Priorities describe the project plan and should not be interpreted as proof that every listed feature is already complete.